CORVANE SYSTEMS

Document ID	HSE-004
Version	2.0
Effective date	1 January 2026
Owner	Facilities & Workplace Safety, with the People Team
Applies to	All employees, in the office and when working from home

Ergonomics and Home Workstation Guide

1. Why ergonomics matters

Most of us spend many hours a day at a screen. Poor posture and long periods without moving can lead to neck, back, shoulder and wrist pain, eye strain and headaches. Most of these problems can be prevented with a well set-up workstation and regular movement. This guide applies equally to the office and to your home workstation.

2. Setting up your workstation

Adjust in this order: chair first, then desk, then screen, then keyboard and mouse.

Chair

- Sit back in the chair so your lower back is supported by the backrest. Adjust the lumbar support to the curve of your lower back.
- Set the seat height so your **feet are flat** on the floor (or on a footrest) and your **knees are at about hip level**.
- Leave a gap of about **two to four fingers** between the front edge of the seat and the back of your knees.

Desk, keyboard and mouse

- Your **elbows should be bent at about 90 degrees**, close to your body, with forearms roughly horizontal.
- Keep your wrists straight while typing. Do not rest your wrists on a sharp desk edge.
- Keep the mouse close to the keyboard, so you do not have to reach for it.

Screen

- Place the screen at **arm's length**, about **50 to 70 cm** from your eyes.
- The **top of the screen should be at or slightly below eye level**. If you wear varifocal glasses, place the screen a little lower.
- With two screens used equally, place them side by side with the join in front of you. If one screen is your main screen, put it directly in front of you.
- Avoid glare: place screens at a right angle to windows, not facing or backing onto them.

Laptops

A laptop on its own forces you to choose between a good screen height and a good keyboard position. If you use a laptop for **more than 2 hours** a day, use a laptop stand with a separate keyboard and mouse, or connect it to an external monitor.

3. Move regularly

- Take a **micro-break** of 1 to 2 minutes every **30 minutes**: stand up, stretch your shoulders, change position.
- Stand up and move for at least **5 minutes every hour**, for example by taking calls while walking.
- Follow the **20-20-20 rule** for your eyes: every **20 minutes**, look at something about **20 feet (6 metres)** away for **20 seconds**.
- Height-adjustable desks are available in all offices. Alternate between sitting and standing; standing all day is not better than sitting all day.

4. Home workstation

Equipment allowance

Employees with a hybrid or remote working arrangement can claim a one-off **home workstation allowance of up to €400** to buy an office chair, monitor, keyboard, mouse or laptop stand. The allowance can be claimed again every **3 years**. Claims are submitted in ExpenseHub with the receipts within **60 days** of purchase. You keep the equipment you buy with the allowance.

Corvane also lends a standard monitor and docking station to every hybrid and remote employee on request.

Self-assessment

Complete the online **Workstation Self-Assessment** within your first **2 weeks** at Corvane, and again whenever you move house or change your setup. If the assessment shows a risk, Facilities will contact you within 10 working days to help, which may include a video assessment with an ergonomics specialist.

Safety at home

- Make sure cables do not cross walkways and that sockets are not overloaded.
- Have a working smoke detector in your home.
- Keep your workspace well lit; a desk lamp helps to reduce eye strain in the evening.
- An accident or injury that happens while working from home must be reported in SafetyHub within **24 hours**, just like an office accident.

5. Recognising problems early

Report discomfort early, before it becomes an injury. Warning signs include:

- pain, tingling or numbness in the hands, wrists or arms;
- regular neck, shoulder or back pain after work;
- eye strain, blurred vision or frequent headaches.

Talk to your manager or the People Team. Corvane can arrange an appointment with the **occupational health service**, adapted equipment (such as a vertical mouse or a split keyboard) and, if needed, temporary changes to your work. Every employee who uses a screen for most of their working day can also have a **free eye test every 2 years**; if glasses are needed specifically for screen work, Corvane contributes up to **€150** towards them.

6. Quick checklist

- Feet flat, knees at hip level, back supported.
- Elbows at about 90 degrees, wrists straight.
- Screen at arm's length, top at or slightly below eye level.
- Laptop raised, with separate keyboard and mouse, for more than 2 hours of use.
- Micro-break every 30 minutes; move 5 minutes every hour; 20-20-20 for your eyes.

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